c. Find the words from the passage which mean the same as the following.

a. risk undertaken (para 3)

b. to protect (para 6)

c. temporary (para 15)

d. Make sentences of your own using the words given below.

a. sedated b. agonising

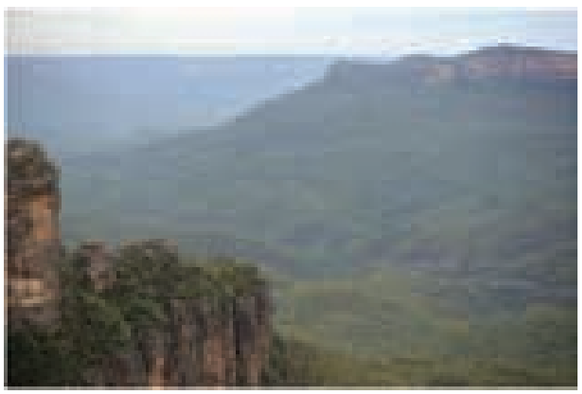
c. manoeuvre d. accomplished

e. Read the following poem carefully:

Hard Is The Journey
By Li Po

Gold vessels of fine wines,
thousands a gallon,
Jade dishes of rare meats,
costing more thousands,

I lay my chopsticks down,
no more can banquet,
I draw my sword and stare
wildly about me:

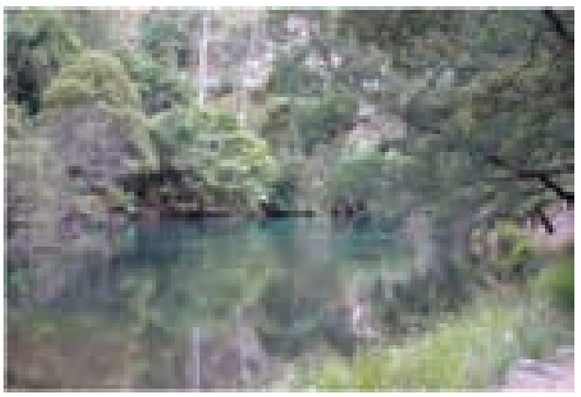


Ice bars my way to cross
the Yellow River,
Snows from dark skies to climb
the T'ai-hang mountains!

At peace I drop a hook
into a brooklet,
At once I'm in a boat
but sailing sunward...

(Hard is the journey,
Hard is the journey,
So many turnings,
And now where am I?)

So when a breeze breaks waves,
bringing fair weather,
I set a cloud for sails,
cross the blue oceans!



Glossary

1. **gallon (n)** – liquid measure of eight pints or 4.55 litres
2. **jade (n)** – semi precious stone of dark green colour
3. **chopsticks (n)** – pair of thin sticks used to eat Chinese food
4. **banquet (n)** – elaborate formal dinner

f. Answer the following questions carefully.

1. What is the first stanza of the poem about?
2. Why do you think the poet's tone changes in the second stanza?
3. What obstacles create the tension in the poet?
4. On what note does the poet end the poem?

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